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Brand Bible

How we sound. How we look. How we don't.

SHERPA PROS INTERNAL TEACHING DECK FOR EVERY PSM, CONCIERGE, BD REP, AND AI AGENT

v1 · 2026-04-24 · Read this before you write a single sentence on our behalf

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Who Sherpa Pros is

> *The licensed-trade marketplace that thinks like a contractor. Built by a working GC. Code-aware. Permit-aware. Rebate-aware.*

We are the **national** licensed-trade marketplace (international roadmap) — built by a working New Hampshire general contractor for the contractors he hires every week. Launching in NH/ME/MA Phase 1, expanding nationally through Phase 4.

We solve the two things lead-gen platforms structurally cannot: **verified licensed work** and **code-aware matching**.

We are not selling leads. We are sending jobs.

Read this paragraph before you write any external copy. Every line of marketing flows from it.

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Who we are NOT

SAYING WHO WE ARE NOT IS HOW WE SAY WHO WE ARE.

PLATFORM	WHAT THEY DO	WHY WE ARE DIFFERENT
Angi	Sells leads to contractors	We send jobs, not leads. Pros pay only when work happens.
Thumbtack	Sells leads + collects deposits	We hold money in escrow. Documented deposit-theft losses $300–$1,600 are not our model.
TaskRabbit	Unskilled task / assembly	We are licensed trade work. Toilet installs, panels, heat pumps.
Houzz	Designer portfolio + magazine	We move money and dispatch crews. Not a magazine.
Handy	Subscription cleanings + assembly	We are jobs by the job. No subscription bundle.

The licensed + code-aware + true-marketplace quadrant was empty. We planted the flag there.

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Four audiences. One DNA.

SAME BRAND, DIFFERENT HEADLINE PER AUDIENCE. EACH LINE IS APPROVED COPY FROM THE BIBLE (§3.2).

AUDIENCE	HEADLINE
Residential homeowners	Trusted neighbor pros. Real people, verified work, no leads-for-sale.
Specialty / older-home owners	Licensed specialty work. Code-aware. Permit-aware. Rebate-aware. National platforms can't filter for this.

Contractors (national)	Jobs. Not leads. Get paid for work, not for paying to bid.
Property Managers (national)	Work orders, preferred vendors, unit-level finance in one platform. Stop juggling 40 contractors in spreadsheets.

Audience messages reference *use cases* (residential, specialty, older-home, multi-family), not *regions*. Every market has homeowners, specialty work, and property managers. The launch sequence is operational; the audience is national. When you write for an audience, pull their headline. Do not invent a new one. Do not blend two.

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The hero message

The licensed-trade marketplace that thinks like a contractor.

Built by a working GC. Code-aware. Permit-aware. Rebate-aware.

This is the anchor. It appears on every external surface. Memorize it.

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Voice principles

PLAINSPOKEN. DIRECT. TRADESPERSON-FRIENDLY. DRY. ZERO MARKETING-SPEAK. 8TH-GRADE READING LEVEL.

He talks like a guy who actually swung a hammer this morning — because he did.

ON-VOICE — *"I just paid $87 for a lead that ghosted me. The plumber I called paid $112 for the same lead. The 'homeowner' was never real."*

OFF-VOICE — *"Sherpa Pros leverages an AI-powered, next-generation marketplace solution to disrupt the legacy lead-generation paradigm and unlock unprecedented value for the construction ecosystem."*

ON-VOICE — *"A homeowner called me yesterday. She'd had 3 contractors no-show in 2 weeks."*

OFF-VOICE — *"Customer churn driven by supply-side reliability friction is a key vertical opportunity."*

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ALWAYS say

Licensed — every pro on the platform has a current state license we verified.

Verified — license, insurance, and certificate of insurance with the homeowner named as additional insured.

Code-aware — quotes get checked against NEC, IRC, MA Electrical, NH RSA, and 284 NH municipal codes.

Built by a contractor — Phyrom runs HJD Builders. He uses the platform himself.

Local / Neighbor — these are the pros down the street. Treat homeowners as neighbors.

Jobs, not leads — pros pay only when work happens. The whole model in three words.

Founding Pro · Half-price forever — beta cohort grandfathered at 5% take rate forever. Permanent recruiting hook.

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NEVER say

THE BRIGHT LINES. EACH ONE IS BANNED FOR A REASON.

"Wiseman" — internal product name. If it leaks externally we look like an AI gimmick instead of a contractor's tool. Externally call it: *the platform · code validation · permit assist · rebate lookup · the matching engine.*

"Gig" / "Task" — frames our pros as TaskRabbit-style unskilled labor. They are licensed trade.

"Uber for X" externally — internal shorthand only. Externally it cheapens the licensed-trade positioning.

"AI-powered" as headline — investors and pros tune out. AI is supporting cast. The contractor is the lead.

"Disrupt" / "Revolutionize" — buzzword tax. We do not pay it.

Jargon abbreviations on first use — CO, SOV, AR, RFI, ARR, NPS, CAC, GMV. Spell out on first use, then the abbreviation is fine.

Region-anchored brand language — "the New England licensed-trade marketplace," "Sherpa Pros for NH/ME/MA," "the NE marketplace." The brand is **national** (international roadmap). Launch geography is a Phase 1/2/3 sequence, not the brand identity. Spec §3.4 is canonical.

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Geographic brand rules

THIS IS THE RULE THAT TOOK THE LONGEST TO LEARN. READ IT TWICE.

RULE	BRAND LINE
Brand identity	Always **national** (international roadmap). Sherpa Pros is THE national licensed-trade marketplace.
Launch geography	Named operationally where relevant (e.g., "Phase 1 launches in Portsmouth, Manchester, Portland, and Boston"), never as a brand cap.
Founder origin	"Working New Hampshire general contractor" — true, specific, builds trust. Reference Phyrom's NH-GC identity freely; this is biography, not brand cap.
Pricing bands	Keep per-metro operational pricing (NH/ME band, MA band, NYC band as we add them). These are real cost-of-labor differences, not brand statements.
State-specific operational notes	Keep grant programs (MassCEC), trade associations (NHHBA, MEHBA), supply houses (FW Webb), licensing (MA Office of Consumer Affairs) — these are how the work gets done in our launch markets, not brand identity.

RIGHT — *"Sherpa Pros is the national licensed-trade marketplace, launching in NH, ME, and MA — expanding nationally."*

RIGHT — *"Phyrom is a working New Hampshire general contractor running HJD Builders LLC."* (founder biography — true and specific)

WRONG — *"the New England licensed-trade marketplace" | "Sherpa Pros for NH/ME/MA" | "the Northern Triangle marketplace"*

The test: if you removed the region word, would the sentence still make sense in five years when we're operating in Texas? If yes, the word is operational and stays. If no, it's brand-capping and goes.

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The founder story is the lead hook

ALWAYS. SLIDE 1 OF EVERY DECK. LINE 1 OF EVERY PRO RECRUIT. PARAGRAPH 1 OF EVERY PR PLACEMENT.

> *"Hi, I'm Phyrom. I run HJD Builders — a licensed general contractor in New Hampshire."*
>
> *"I built Sherpa Pros because the platforms my crew gets pitched every week — Angi, Thumbtack, TaskRabbit, Handy — sell us leads we can't afford and send homeowners to people who shouldn't be touching their wiring."*

Why this works: people follow people. Logo posts underperform Phyrom's face by 3–5×. Investors back founders, not decks. Pros trust other pros, not platforms.

If your copy does not have Phyrom's voice in the first paragraph, rewrite it.

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Phyrom-specific rules

HIS SURNAME IS **UNKNOWN** UNTIL HE CONFIRMS IT. UNTIL THEN, NEVER WRITE A SURNAME. DO NOT GUESS.

RIGHT — *Phyrom · Founder · NH General Contractor · HJD Builders LLC*

RIGHT — Founder card initials display: **P** (single letter)

WRONG — *Phyrom Doung, founder of Sherpa Pros* (surname guessed — caught in audit P0-1)

WRONG — Founder card initials: **PD** (encodes a guessed surname — caught in audit P0-2)

Run this grep before any external send: `git grep -i "Phyrom [A-Z][a-z]"` — must return zero hits.

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Internal vs external naming

TWO PRODUCT NAMES LIVE INSIDE THE COMPANY. NEITHER ONE SHIPS EXTERNALLY. SUBSTITUTION TABLE:

INTERNAL NAME (DON'T SHIP)	EXTERNAL PHRASE (ALWAYS SHIP)
Wiseman	the platform · code validation · permit assist · rebate lookup · the matching engine
Wiseman code-intelligence	code-aware quote validation
Wiseman-checked	Code-checked
BldSync	the underlying code-intelligence layer
Dispatch Wiseman	the matching engine · 7-factor dispatch

LEAKED (audit P1-1) — *"Founder of Sherpa Pros and the broader BldSync platform that powers the code-aware layer."*

FIXED — *"Founder of Sherpa Pros and the underlying code-intelligence layer that powers code-aware quote validation across the platform."*

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Visual identity

BRAND COLORS

Sky Blue · #00a9e0 — primary. Logo, links, headlines. **Dark Navy · #1a1a2e** — secondary. Body text, headers. **Amber · #f59e0b** — accent. CTAs, "PROS" wordmark, highlights. **Emerald · #10b981** — success. Verified badges, code-checked, completed jobs.

Typography `-apple-system, BlinkMacSystemFont, "Segoe UI", Roboto, Helvetica, Arial, sans-serif` System font stack. Mobile-first. Renders fast on every device. No custom font fees.

Logo lockup Sky-blue **SHERPA** + amber **PROS** with a diagonal cut between the words. Wordmark only — no icon needed.

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Pricing comparison framing

BRAND GUARDIAN AUDIT RECOMMENDED THIS BE STANDARDIZED. PRICING IS A VALUE COMPARISON, NOT A PRICE-SHOPPING COMPARISON.

ALWAYS — *"5% take rate vs Angi's effective $400–$800 per closed job."*

ALWAYS — *"Roughly half the all-in cost a contractor pays Angi today."*

ALWAYS — *"Pros pay only when work happens. Angi sells the same lead 4 times."*

NEVER — *"Cheaper than Angi"*

NEVER — *"Lower fees"*

NEVER — *"Better deal forever"* · *"5 cents on the dollar"*

Why: "cheaper / lower / better deal" invites price-shopping. We invite value comparison. The numbers tell the story; we don't editorialize them.

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Quick Job lane brand consistency

THE HARDEST BRAND CALL WE MADE. QUICK JOBS ($200–$1,500 TOILET INSTALLS, PAINT, CEILING FANS) ARE ON-BRAND BECAUSE THE PROS ARE STILL LICENSED WHERE STATE REQUIRES.

Headline for Quick Job tab:

> *"Real licensed pros. Pre-priced. Confirmed in 30 minutes. The handyman lane Angi can't deliver."*

WE CAN CLAIM — *"Licensed plumber for $325 toilet install — confirmed in 30 minutes."*

WE CAN CLAIM — *"Licensed electricians for ceiling fans and GFCIs at handyman prices."*

WE CANNOT CLAIM — *"Sherpa Pros = licensed-only"* — true for Project mode, mostly true for Quick Job, but handyman general work is unlicensed in many states.

WE CANNOT CLAIM — *"Code-validated"* on every Quick Job — light validation only, not full code engine.

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Common mistakes the Brand Guardian caught

REAL P0 + P1 VIOLATIONS FROM THE AUDIT. EACH ONE IS A PATTERN TO LEARN.

Surname leak — *"Phyrom Doung, founder of Sherpa Pros."* **Right** — *"Phyrom, founder of Sherpa Pros."* **Why it matters:** the surname is unknown. Guessing it forever puts a wrong name in print.

Internal name in deck — *"the broader BldSync platform that powers the code-aware layer."* **Right** — *"the underlying code-intelligence layer that powers code-aware quote validation."* **Why it matters:** investors think we shipped a different product than the one they bought.

Stat contradiction — *Mass Save heat-pump rebate $8,500 max in 2026.* **Right** — *$10,000+ in 2026* (matches deck, one-pager, for-pros, LinkedIn). **Why it matters:** one wrong number in front of an investor reads as "founder doesn't know his own numbers."

Unhyphenated — *"Old House Verified"* **Right** — *"Old-House Verified"* (hyphenated everywhere). **Why it matters:** trademark filing depends on a single canonical spelling.

AI as headline — *"AI-powered marketplace for contractors."* **Right** — *"The licensed-trade marketplace that thinks like a contractor."* **Why it matters:** "AI-powered" is supporting cast. The contractor is the lead.

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The brand owner

PHYROM PERSONALLY OWNS BRAND CALLS. WHEN IN DOUBT, ASK HIM.

The Brand Guardian agent runs final audit before any external send. Spec at `docs/pitch/brand-audit.md`. Run before press, investor pitches, paid ads, and any landing page change.

This deck is the source of truth. Canonical bible: `docs/superpowers/specs/2026-04-22-gtm-marketing-design.md` §3. Audit reference: `docs/pitch/brand-audit.md`.

Refresh cadence: quarterly + after every Brand Guardian audit. Anything that changes here changes downstream — brief the team in the next standup.

Three-question gut check before you hit send:

1. Does the founder voice lead?
2. Did I use any banned word? (Wiseman, BldSync, gig, task, AI-powered, disrupt, revolutionize, cheaper)
3. Does Phyrom appear with no surname?